

Nate Harris

ADV-0853

Temple University Wawa Ad Campaign

Wawa lists its core values as, “Value People”, “Delight Customers”, “Embrace Change”, “Do the Right Thing”, “Do Things Right”, and “Passion for Winning”. Being a semi-frequent Wawa customer some of these values manifest in a fast-paced experience one might expect at a gas station. You go in, order your food, get a drink, pay, get your food and then leave. The food probably isn’t the best, but it is more than good enough for the price and calorie count. Temple undergrads are commonly aged 18-22. Many don’t keep to the meal plan as the dining hall food isn’t the greatest. I see many moving around campus and many people I know tend to stack their classes, especially commuters. This could mean a quick breakfast or lunch would be valuable for a Temple student with this kind of schedule. Also, most college kids are broke, so cheap food is great too. For a student with a busy schedule Wawa’s affordable pricing and consistency could be a driving force for patronage by Temple undergrads.

The most notable competitors on Temple Campus, in my opinion, would be Ritchie’s Café, 7-11 and the Panera Bread in Pearson. All of these locations fill a niche in Temple campus that Wawa would prefer to have priority in. The main advantages Ritchie’s has are its locations and pricing. I will often walk past Ritchie’s on my way to my second class and every rail commuter walks past it twice on the way to class, assuming they walk straight up from the station to campus and not on Norris. During this rush period, Ritchie’s has 20+ cups of iced coffee ready to be purchased and quickly deals with the large customer rushes. Wawa would struggle pretty hard to compete for this customer base, although they would be able to offer more competitive pricing that may drive some away as well as a larger and more customizable selection of food as well as snacks. They would also have an advantage in the market of people who live west (I think) of Broad in the side away from Campus. Many people walk through

Cecil or Montgomery on the way to class especially now that the parking lot/pathway that leads into Polett walk is closed for construction. This would lead the natural path of these people to the Wawa, this would give it an advantage in this market compared to all the other competitors except for the 7-11 on Cecil B. Moore and maybe the Panera. It is also closer to the subway station that gives it a huge advantage in that commuter market. The appeal of 7-11 is mostly in the consumables like energy/soft drinks and nicotine products as well as stuff like toilet paper and detergent. It also has an on campus location close to J&H and 1940 as well as being close to the library which is advantages for people who snack while studying. Panera is a concern because it is close and you can pay with meal swipes. People may prefer Panera's food too. Generally though, Wawa's advantage is having most of what these other places offer and often cheaper. Maybe you aren't getting tip-top quality, but you are definitely saving money on something that will satisfy you similarly.

Based on these observations Wawa's ad campaign would need to be one that raises awareness and encourages students to save money by purchasing their commonly bought items at Wawa instead of the other places. I do not think it would need a large scale campaign as the majority of people in Pennsylvania are aware of Wawa as a brand and the majority of the customer base would likely be college students within walking distance. I think the best angle would be advertising affordability and hosting events partnered with the school. They could host a grand opening with free hot coffee on one of the first days of next fall semester. This would get many people to go in and maybe make a habit of doing so. Advertising a cheap breakfast deal with posters on campus that would beat out Ritchie's and Panera. It would also be a good idea if they could accept campus currency and meal swipes to make it more accessible. Generally an all-purpose gas-station type store would be greatly accepted into the Temple environment. The best way to drive sales would be to inform as many people on campus that it is there and is cheaper. Showing deals on the campus posters with already commonly bought items would be smart and once there is a large enough consumer base many people will go to the Wawa out of habit. With people coming in from the subway and off campus housing they would likely be able to

maintain a steady influx of revenue. I think the hardest part would be acquiring the location, but college students would definitely be accepting of the kind of services and products Wawa offers. They already are, but having it all in one place would be even better for a busy Temple undergrad.

Sources

Wawa. "About Us." Wawa, www.wawa.com/about-us.